

**DEPARTMENT OF VETERANS AFFAIRS
STATEMENT IN SUPPORT OF CLAIM**

VA FORM 21-4138

★ SYNTHETIC TRAINING DOCUMENT – AI RESEARCH USE ONLY – NOT AN OFFICIAL VA DOCUMENT ★

REGARDING THE CLAIM OF:

Veteran Name: CADUCEUS, OPUS J.
VA File Number: [REDACTED]
Service: USN, 1976-2015 (Retired, Senior Chief Petty Officer, AWCS)

STATEMENT MADE BY:

Name: HOLLOWAY, ROBERT W.
Rank/Grade: COMMANDER (CDR), USN (Retired)
Relationship: Former squadronmate, VP-4 SKINNY DRAGONS
Period: 1979-1982 (NAS Barbers Point, HI / Johnston Island)

DATE OF STATEMENT: 08 October 2024

STATEMENT

I, Robert W. Holloway, CDR USN (Ret.), make the following sworn statement in support of the disability claim of my former shipmate Opus J. Caduceus.

I served as a P-3C Orion Naval Flight Officer with VP-4 Skinny Dragons at NAS Barbers Point, Hawaii from approximately mid-1979 through early 1982. During that period I knew Opus Caduceus as a fellow aircrew member of the squadron. We both rotated through detachment operations from Barbers Point to Johnston Island in support of Pacific theater anti-submarine warfare patrols.

I personally observed Petty Officer Caduceus at the Johnston Island detachment site on multiple occasions during the 1979-1981 timeframe. Aircrew personnel were on the ground at the island for extended periods between sorties, often days at a time. While deployed to Johnston Island, we were exposed to a range of environmental hazards that were a known feature of duty at that location.

It was common knowledge among personnel assigned to Johnston Island during this period that the location had previously stored Agent Orange and other tactical herbicides. The drums and storage facilities were still visible at the site during my time there, and personnel were routinely warned to avoid certain areas because of contamination concerns. Petty Officer Caduceus and I shared sleeping quarters, mess facilities, and ground transportation at the detachment site and were exposed to the same environmental conditions during the same operational period.

I make this statement in good faith and to the best of my recollection. I declare under penalty of perjury under the laws of the United States of America that the foregoing is true and correct.

Date: 08 October 2024

Robert W. Holloway, CDR USN (Ret.)

PENALTY: The law provides severe penalties which include fine or imprisonment, or both, for the willful submission of any statement or evidence of a material fact, knowing it to be false, or for the fraudulent acceptance of any payment to which you are not entitled.

★ SYNTHETIC TRAINING DOCUMENT – AI RESEARCH USE ONLY – NOT AN OFFICIAL VA DOCUMENT ★